

Brief CV – Giles M. Whitcomb

U.N. Related Consultancies - Summary (since January 1990)

Humanitarianism and War Project, Brown University.

- Assistance in initiating research program for Phase 3 (1997-1998).
- Review of Phases 1&2 – Implications for Phase 3 (1996)
- Contributor to “A Guide to Peace Support Operations” (1995)

United Nations Volunteers (UNV)/United Nations Development Program (UNDP).

- Team Leader, Thematic Evaluation of UNV Program in Humanitarian Assistance, Peacebuilding Activities and Democratisation Processes (1995).
- Team Leader, Evaluation of UNTAC/UNV Collaboration (1993).

United Nations Development Program (UNDP) – New York.

- Co-Consultant drafting UNDP/UNDRO Disaster Management Manual (1993).
- Team Leader, mid-term Review of Joint UNDP/DHA Disaster Management Training Program (DMTP) (1992-1993).

United Nations Development Program (UNDP) – Indonesia.

- Program support and project formulation – Strengthening Disaster Management in Indonesia (Phase 2) and Senior Technical Advisor, Preparatory Assistance Project (1990-93).

International Decade for Natural Disaster Reduction (IDNDR)

- Consultant to the Secretariat in strategic planning and early warning. (1995-96).

Department for Humanitarian Affairs/UNDRO, United Nations Secretariat.

- Project Manager, Project IERRIS (International Emergency Readiness and Response Information System) (1994).

Department for Humanitarian Affairs-/UNDRO, United Nations Secretariat (Geneva).

- Establishment and Officer-in-Charge of an Information Management Branch and conceptualization of Project IERRIS (1992).

Office of the United Nations Disaster Relief Coordinator (UNDRO), United Nations Secretariat.

- Consultant to the Office on planning, organization, and information systems development (1991).
- Assessment of and recommendations on enhancement of information management, communications and office systems (1990).

Also:

Asian Development Bank/Asian Disaster Preparedness Center – Bangkok.

- Groundwork on disaster mitigation policy study for the Philippines (1990).

United Nations Service – Summary (June 1978-December 1989)

On permanent contract with UN Secretariat (UNDRO), based in Geneva, until resignation as Principal Officer (P5) for family reasons.

Varied and increasing responsibilities international disaster relief, disaster mitigation, and inter-organizational affairs. Assignments as Officer-in-Charge, UNDRO office, U.N. Hqtrs., N.Y.

Main relief and technical assistance assignments involving senior-level bilateral, inter-organizational and governmental working relationships: Algeria, El Asnam earthquake (Oct-Nov’80), Indonesia, Mt. Galunggung volcanic emergency (sept-Oct’82); Chad, drought, civil strife and expellees from Nigeria (Oct’82-Mar’83); Philippines, Typhoon Nitang (Sept-Oct’84); Sudan, drought and civil strife (Jan-Jun’85); Haiti economic emergency (Mar-Jun’86); technical assistance: Indonesia (3-yr. UNDP/USAID project to strengthen national disaster management), Asia Region (establishment/collaboration with Asian Disaster Preparedness Center, AIT-Bangkok). Ad hoc technical cooperation missions to: Algeria, China, Malaysia, Mexico, Nepal, Papua New Guinea, Somalia, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Togo, Tunisia.

Brief CV - Giles M. Whitcomb

Giles MacNair Whitcomb (US citizen, married, four children)

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Email: gmwhitcomb@cs.com

Born: 22 December 1943 in Baden-Baden, Germany.

Education

1962-'66: Harvard University (BA cum laude), Massachusetts, U.S.A.

1959-'62: South Kent School, Connecticut, U.S.A.

1958-'59: American Community School, Paris, France

1952-'57: Desmoor School, Surrey, England.

Professional***Currently.***

- **Independent Consultant and Director of E.S.I.**, a small firm providing support in interim management, planning and evaluation mainly to international programs and organizations.

Employment.

- **Independent Consultant** - since 1990 (based in Geneva '90-'96): Assignments with different U.N. organizations and related research groups - evaluations, policy formulation and technical assistance in various aspects of disaster/emergency management, international humanitarian interventions and peace support operations. (See p.2 for summary of consultancies.)
- **United Nations Secretariat** (1978-1989): Office of the United Nations Disaster Relief Co-ordinator (based in Geneva). Responsibilities in international emergency response and technical assistance in various countries of SE Asia, northern Africa, and the Caribbean and in related U.N. inter-agency affairs in Geneva and New York. (See p.2 for summary.)
- **Harvard University Administration** (1974-1978): Executive Assistant in the Program for Science and International Affairs. Various management functions related to the Program's establishment
- **US Navy** (1966-1970, reactivated 1971, 1972): Line/legal officer aboard USS Little Rock, 6th Fleet Flagship; Staff officer, Commander U.S. Naval Forces, Saigon. Hold US Naval Reserve (ret.) rank Lt. Cdr.

Areas of Interest: governance; emergency and peace support operations; organizational development.

Professional Strengths: problem solving/trouble-shooting; analysis; conceptualization;.

Languages: fluent French, medium fluency in Italian; working Spanish.

Boards of Directors: United Nations Association of Greater Boston; Traditions for Tomorrow (Swiss/French/US NGO supporting cultural affirmation of Indians in Central and South America); Cambridge-Ellis School, Cambridge, Mass.

References on request.

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